National Grid: Halt Construction on the non-essential infrastructure: North Brooklyn "MRI" Pipeline during Governor Andrew M. Cuomo's Executive Order "New York State on PAUSE"

March 23, 2020
Delivered via EMAIL

To: John Bruckner, President of National Grid New York john.bruckner@nationalgrid.com
cc: Honorable Andrew Cuomo, Governor of New York State via online form
cc: Commissioner John Rhodes, Chair of New York State Public Service Commission john.rhodes@dps.ny.gov
cc: Secretary Michelle Phillips of the New York State Public Service Commission secretary@dps.ny.gov

Dear Mr. Bruckner,

We, the undersigned, are calling on National Grid to immediately halt construction of the Metropolitan Reliability Infrastructure (MRI) project for the health and safety of construction workers and the North Brooklyn community.

As of March 19, 2020, workers were seen on the construction site in close proximity to one another, putting themselves and our community at risk by being in clear violation of suggested CDC social distancing practices. And in the construction update emailed out by National Grid on March 23, the company says they intend to continue construction along at least 5 North Brooklyn streets this week.

In light of ABC-7 reporting that a Consolidated Edison construction worker has tested positive for COVID-19[1], it is only appropriate for New York utilities to take the necessary precautions to protect their workers and the communities in which they work and halt construction.

The North Brooklyn community has never consented to this pipeline being built through our neighborhoods, using our rate payer dollars and for National Grid to continue to potentially expose our community to novel coronavirus shows a further lack of disregard for our safety.

Furthermore, once construction is halted in response to the current public health crisis, we encourage you to read the hundreds of public comments submitted by our community and ratepayers across New York in Case 19-G-0309, requesting that no more ratepayer dollars be approved for the MRI pipeline and that construction be halted permanently to address the climate crisis and safety of our community.

Sincerely,

[1] https://abc7ny.com/6022486/

Elected Officials

Assemblymember Joseph Lentol, 50th Assembly District, New York
NYC Council Stephen Levin, District 33, New York City
District Assembly Leader Nick Rizzo 50th Assembly District, New York

Local Residents of North Brooklyn, National Grid Customers

Mr. Jonathan Jackson
Ms. Richenda Kramer
Jenna London
Danielle Franco
Francoise
Augusta Gordon
Kevin Lacherra
Sarah Axtell
Cynthia Boyson
Lynn Del Sol
Steve Chesler
Lian Calvo
Joanna Zdziaszek
Margot Spindelman
Li Jackson
Devon Mcconaghy
Katherine Thompson
Tracey Tierney
Daeha Ko
Stephen Levin
Laura Hofmann
Chahui Cain
Erika Chamberlin
Anthony
Laura Hofmann
Deborah Spiroff
Michael Hofmann
Jane Pool
Kat Egan
Jason Phillips
Katarina Pittis
Jen Chantrtanapichate
Christina Mei Edwards
Lisa Bloodgood
Candice Brooklyn
Max Uhlenbeck
Dr. Michael R Kay, Dacm
Scott Valins
Penny Overbaugh
Paige Stevenson
Barbara Hertel
Shannan Shaughnessy
Jessica Mullen
Hallie Glickman-hoch
Clifford Beinart
Lee Ziesche
Maggie Brooklyn
Coleman Camp
Kiley Brooklyn
Steve Fox
Josefa Vincent
Alex Mackinnon
Malik Marshall
Kim A. Fraczek
Shosh Yuni
Alicia Fox
Claire Haughey
Willis Elkins
Esmeralda Huerta
Monica Hunken
Kevin A Towler
Kathryn Pope
Cal Fish
Janine Ko
Sarah Lilley
Alison Dieguez
Victoria Rich

Neighboring National Grid Customers and New York Constituents

Heidi Vanderlee
Katie Leung
Johanna Fallert
Ian Kinniburgh
Eve Silber
Stephen Shafer
Beverley Birks
Carolina Moya
Barbara Harris
Susan Dubois
Mary Finneran
Joseph Wilson
Daniel Horn, Aia
Kimberley Smith
Joan Roney
Monica Weiss
Joan Mckiernan
Gabrielle Engh
Carol De Angelo
Jo-anne Chasnow
Becky J Meier
Cynthia Carestio
Jenny Bock
Aaron Eisenberg
Maura Stephens
Timothy Kent
Janet Aisawa
Jenny Romaine
Margo J Gregory
Chloe Holden
Alexandra Zevin
Carolyn Weaver
Paul Zimmerman
Mark Phelan
Noelle Picone
Peter Drobny
Elizabeth Mellen
Barbara Warren, Rn, Ms
Sandra Steubing
Cal Trumann
Jackie Weisberg
Ruth Foster
Dara Winfield
Jill Mcmanus

John Ingram
Alexia Weidler
Don Lieber
Rebecca
Morgan Jenness
Ellen S Blum
Tara Escudero
Doug Couchon
Chris Gentry
Annie Garneva
Lorena Gonzalez
Ann Schneider
Michaela
Ken Schles
Thomas Niles
Jennifer Davis
Dominique Thomas
Meenakshi Poolapalli
Abby Brooklyn
Patti Bradshaw
Jessica Rechtschaffer
Thomas Ross
Elisa Zazzera
Linda Snider
Paulette Osborne
Mike G Bucci
Laura Shindell
Billii Roberti
Irene Weiser
Michele Fox
Stephanie Goulet
Dawne
Peggy Ray
Jessica L Clegg
Betta Broad
George Povall
Andrea Lomanto
Wendy Brawer
Nicole
Nancy Vann
Miles Mcmanus
Donna Frankel

Jenny Heinz
Bayard Faithfull
Nydia Leaf
Angela Manno
Alice Slater
Alexander Betser
Aly Halpert
Marie Young
Margaret Human
White Feather Curtiss
Alice Sturm Sutter
Amy Rosmarin
Carol Maltby
Matt Wynne
Marti Richenstein
Sara Gronim
Nicole Karsch
Michael Davis
Laurel Tumarkin
Gavi Reiter
Marlow Murphy
Galicia Outes
Sarah Blust
Jessica Roff
Marilyn Ackerman
John Rath
Robert Wood
Lee Zimmerman
Mimi Bluestone
James Hill
Jake Barczak
Alex Crowley
John Head
Ann Rauch
Jennifer Scarlott
Dwain Wilder
Jean Belford
Joan Flynn
Sue Rosenberg
Michaela Ciovacco
Mary Menapace Rn
Avni Pravin
Maria Seales

Organizations

Sane Energy Project

Lee Ziesche, Community Engagement Coordinator
Kim A. Fraczek, Director
Core Team Members:
George Elliot, Timothy Kent, Monica Hunken, Annie Garneva, Thomas Ross

350.Org
Dominique Thomas
Mid-atlantic Regional Organizer

350 Brooklyn
Sara Gronim, Robert Wood, Jackie Weisberg, Marti Richenstein

350NYC
John Ingram, Martha Saxton

AIA Architect
Daniel Horn, Aia

All Our Energy
George Poval, Executive Director

Alliance For A Green Economy

Jessica Azulay

Executive Director

Brooklyn Barge Park Pals

Michael Hofmann

Co-founder

Binghamton Regional Sustainability Coalition

Adam Flint

Director Of Clean Energy Programs

Brandworkers

Esmeralda Huerta

Labor Organizer

Bronx Climate Justice North & North Bronx Racial Justice;

Jennifer Scarlott

Coordinator

Brooklyn Bar Association

Carol Lipton Esq.

Manhattan Buddhist Climate Action Network

Robert Kolodny

Executive Director

Citizens For Local Power

Jessica L Clegg

Coordinator

Cuddebackville Citizens' Environmental Coalition

Barbara Warren, Rn, Ms

Executive Director

Coalition Against Pilgrim Pipelines, E3c

Sue Rosenberg

Coalition For Policy, Outreach, And Education

Joseph Wilson

Co-coordinator

Coalition To Protect New York

Maura Stephens

Concerned Families Of Westchester

Linda Snider

Deep Green Resistance New York City

Mike G Bucci

Projects Coordinator

Democratic Socialists of America North Brooklyn Chapter

Malik Marshall

Elmirans And Friends Against Fracking

Doug Couchon

Co-founder

Food & Water Action
Laura Shindell
Organizer

Fossil Free Tompkins
Irene Weiser
Coordinator

Frack Free Genesee
Cynthia Carestio

Friends Of Transmitter Park
Francoise Olivas

Granny Peace Brigade
Barbara Harris

Great Small Works
Jenny Romaine
Coordinator

Green Map System
Wendy Brawer
Director

Greenpoint Psychotherapy
Augusta Gordon

Hells Kitchen Democrats
Paulette Osborne

National Lawyers Guild
Ann Schneider
Attorney

New York Communities For Change
Patrick Houston
Climate & Inequality Campaigns Associate

New York Interfaith Power & Light
Elizabeth Mellen

Member

New Yorkers For Clean Power
Betta Broad, Director,
Michaela Ciovacco, Program Coordinator

No Nbk Pipeline
Daeha Ko

North Bronx Racial Justice
Jennifer Scarlott
Coordinator

Nyc-dsa
Chris Gentry

Nyc-dsa Ecosocialists
Thomas Niles, Aaron Eisenberg

Nypirg
Elizabeth Moran, Environmental Policy Director
Lorena Gonzalez, Student

Occupy Bergen County
Sally Jane Gellert

People For A Healthy Environment
Doug Couchon
Co-founder, Board Member

Queens Dsa & Ridgewood Tenants Union
Alex Crowley

Rockaway Women For Progress
Jean Belford, President
Joan Flynn, Member

Safe Energy Rights Group (Senrg)
Nancy Vann
Co-chair

United For Action
Beverley Birks

Sixth Street Community Center
Jen Chantrtanapichate
Program Director

Solstice Initiative, Inc.
Avni Pravin

Sunrise Movement Nyc
Maggie Berke, Nicole Karsch

Surfrider Foundation, Nyc Chapter
Noelle Picone
Campaign Lead, Williams Pipeline

The Banner
Dwain Wilder
Editor/Publisher

The Pilling Street Block Association
Shosh Yuni
Secretary

Uptown Progressive Action
Alice Sturm Sutter
Member

We Are Seneca Lake
Peter Drobny